# 100 Idioms & Phrases – MCQ Practice

Competitive / Placement Exam Style • Solution immediately below every question

**How to use:** Try each question first, then read the explanation. The solution explains the correct idiom and why the other three options do not fit.

**1. The school administration found the bullying complaint to be _____.**

A. a feather in his cap
B. a hot potato
C. a piece of cake
D. a bed of roses

**Answer: B. a hot potato**
**Meaning:** a sensitive or controversial issue.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** a feather in his cap → an achievement to be proud of. **C.** a piece of cake → something very easy. **D.** a bed of roses → a very easy or pleasant situation.

**2. The basic coding question was _____ for the experienced candidate.**

A. a storm in a teacup
B. a wild goose chase
C. a piece of cake
D. a hot potato

**Answer: C. a piece of cake**
**Meaning:** something very easy.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** a storm in a teacup → a lot of fuss about a small matter. **B.** a wild goose chase → a pointless search. **D.** a hot potato → a sensitive or controversial issue.

**3. Life in a new city is not always _____.**

A. a red herring
B. a hot potato
C. a white elephant
D. a bed of roses

**Answer: D. a bed of roses**
**Meaning:** a very easy or pleasant situation.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** a red herring → something that misleads or distracts. **B.** a hot potato → a sensitive or controversial issue. **C.** a white elephant → an expensive but useless possession or project.

**4. The abandoned stadium became _____ because it cost millions to maintain.**

A. a white elephant
B. a piece of cake
C. a silver lining
D. a red-letter day

**Answer: A. a white elephant**
**Meaning:** an expensive but useless possession or project.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** a piece of cake → something very easy. **C.** a silver lining → a positive aspect of a difficult situation. **D.** a red-letter day → a very important or memorable day.

**5. The clue about the old car was _____ and sent the detective in the wrong direction.**

A. a piece of cake
B. a red herring
C. a feather in his cap
D. a bed of roses

**Answer: B. a red herring**
**Meaning:** something that misleads or distracts.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** a piece of cake → something very easy. **C.** a feather in his cap → an achievement to be proud of. **D.** a bed of roses → a very easy or pleasant situation.

**6. Missing that flight was _____ because she met her future employer later.**

A. a wet blanket
B. a wild goose chase
C. a blessing in disguise
D. a hot potato

**Answer: C. a blessing in disguise**
**Meaning:** something that seems bad but has a good result.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** a wet blanket → a person who spoils others' enjoyment. **B.** a wild goose chase → a pointless search. **D.** a hot potato → a sensitive or controversial issue.

**7. Their argument turned out to be _____ and ended quickly.**

A. a white elephant
B. a red-letter day
C. a piece of cake
D. a storm in a teacup

**Answer: D. a storm in a teacup**
**Meaning:** a lot of fuss about a small matter.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** a white elephant → an expensive but useless possession or project. **B.** a red-letter day → a very important or memorable day. **C.** a piece of cake → something very easy.

**8. The false address sent the police on _____.**

A. a wild goose chase
B. a silver lining
C. a feather in his cap
D. a bed of roses

**Answer: A. a wild goose chase**
**Meaning:** a pointless search.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** a silver lining → a positive aspect of a difficult situation. **C.** a feather in his cap → an achievement to be proud of. **D.** a bed of roses → a very easy or pleasant situation.

**9. The noisy neighbour became _____ for the family.**

A. a blessing in disguise
B. a thorn in the flesh
C. a red-letter day
D. a piece of cake

**Answer: B. a thorn in the flesh**
**Meaning:** a persistent source of annoyance.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** a blessing in disguise → something that seems bad but has a good result. **C.** a red-letter day → a very important or memorable day. **D.** a piece of cake → something very easy.

**10. The unpaid bill became _____ between the partners.**

A. a silver lining

B. a white elephant

C. a bone of contention

D. a hot potato

**Answer: C. a bone of contention**
**Meaning:** a subject causing disagreement.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** a silver lining → a positive aspect of a difficult situation. **B.** a white elephant → an expensive but useless possession or project. **D.** a hot potato → a sensitive or controversial issue.

**11. Winning the national award was _____ for the young scientist.**

A. a wet blanket

B. a red herring

C. a storm in a teacup

D. a feather in his cap

**Answer: D. a feather in his cap**
**Meaning:** an achievement to be proud of.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** a wet blanket → a person who spoils others' enjoyment. **B.** a red herring → something that misleads or distracts. **C.** a storm in a teacup → a lot of fuss about a small matter.

**12. The company's first international launch was _____.**

A. a red-letter day

B. a wild goose chase

C. a piece of cake

D. a hot potato

**Answer: A. a red-letter day**
**Meaning:** a very important or memorable day.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** a wild goose chase → a pointless search. **C.** a piece of cake → something very easy. **D.** a hot potato → a sensitive or controversial issue.

**13. His constant complaints made him _____ at the party.**

A. a red herring

B. a wet blanket

C. a feather in his cap

D. a silver lining

**Answer: B. a wet blanket**
**Meaning:** a person who spoils others' enjoyment.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** a red herring → something that misleads or distracts. **C.** a feather in his cap → an achievement to be proud of. **D.** a silver lining → a positive aspect of a difficult situation.

**14. The only _____ was that nobody was injured in the accident.**

A. a bone of contention

B. a wild goose chase

C. a silver lining

D. a white elephant

**Answer: C. a silver lining**
**Meaning:** a positive aspect of a difficult situation.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** a bone of contention → a subject causing disagreement. **B.** a wild goose chase → a pointless search. **D.** a white elephant → an expensive but useless possession or project.

**15. We have finished the main task, so let's _____.**

A. spill the beans

B. jump the gun

C. burn bridges

D. call it a day

**Answer: D. call it a day**
**Meaning:** stop working for the day.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** spill the beans → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** jump the gun → act too soon. **C.** burn bridges → destroy a relationship or possibility of returning.

**16. The trainer told a joke to _____ at the beginning of the workshop.**

A. break the ice

B. cut corners

C. miss the boat

D. bite the bullet

**Answer: A. break the ice**
**Meaning:** make people feel more comfortable.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** cut corners → do something cheaply/carelessly by skipping proper steps. **C.** miss the boat → lose an opportunity. **D.** bite the bullet → face a difficult situation bravely.

**17. The analyst _____ when she identified poor planning as the main cause.**

A. pull someone's leg

B. hit the nail on the head

C. beat around the bush

D. throw in the towel

**Answer: B. hit the nail on the head**
**Meaning:** identify something exactly.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** pull someone's leg → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** beat around the bush → avoid saying something directly. **D.** throw in the towel → give up.

**18. Stop _____ and tell me what actually happened.**

A. going cold turkey

B. hitting the sack

C. beating around the bush

D. calling the shots

**Answer: C. beating around the bush**
**Meaning:** avoid saying something directly.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** going cold turkey → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** hitting the sack → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** calling the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**19. Ravi accidentally _____ about the surprise party.**

A. cut the mustard

B. kept his powder dry

C. hit the jackpot

D. spilled the beans

**Answer: D. spilled the beans**
**Meaning:** reveal a secret.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** cut the mustard → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** kept his powder dry → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** hit the jackpot → had great success or obtained something valuable.

**20. He _____ just before giving his first public speech.**

A. got cold feet

B. called it a day

C. brought home the bacon

D. saw eye to eye

**Answer: A. got cold feet**

**Meaning:** become nervous before doing something.

**Why other options are wrong: B.** called it a day → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** brought home the bacon → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** saw eye to eye → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**21. She decided to _____ and pay the unexpected repair bill.**

A. break the bank

B. bite the bullet

C. miss the boat

D. pull the plug

**Answer: B. bite the bullet**
**Meaning:** face a difficult situation bravely.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** break the bank → cost a very large amount. **C.** miss the boat → lose an opportunity. **D.** pull the plug → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**22. I did not want to attend, but my friends _____.**

A. hit the sack

B. read the riot act

C. twisted my arm

D. cut corners

**Answer: C. twisted my arm**
**Meaning:** persuade someone.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** hit the sack → go to bed. **B.** read the riot act → strongly reprimand or warn. **D.** cut corners → do something cheaply/carelessly by skipping proper steps.

**23. Don't _____; the mistake can be corrected easily.**

A. keep an eye on

B. call it a day

C. go the extra mile

D. make a mountain out of a molehill

**Answer: D. make a mountain out of a molehill**
**Meaning:** exaggerate a small problem.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** keep an eye on → watch carefully. **B.** call it a day → stop working for the day. **C.** go the extra mile → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**24. The two managers do not always _____ on financial matters.**

A. see eye to eye

B. throw in the towel

C. go bananas

D. draw a blank

**Answer: A. see eye to eye**
**Meaning:** agree completely.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** throw in the towel → give up. **C.** go bananas → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** draw a blank → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**25. I am exhausted, so I am going to _____ early.**

A. hit the nail on the head

B. hit the sack

C. hit the roof

D. hit the jackpot

**Answer: B. hit the sack**
**Meaning:** go to bed.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** hit the nail on the head → identify something exactly. **C.** hit the roof → became extremely angry. **D.** hit the jackpot → had great success or obtained something valuable.

**26. Please _____ and tell us whether the proposal was accepted.**

A. put on airs

B. spill the beans

C. cut to the chase

D. beat around the bush

**Answer: C. cut to the chase**
**Meaning:** get to the main point.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** put on airs → behave as if one is more important. **B.** spill the beans → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** beat around the bush → avoid saying something directly.

**27. His angry reply only _____ during the argument.**

A. kept the wolf from the door

B. broke the ice

C. called it a day

D. added fuel to the fire

**Answer: D. added fuel to the fire**
**Meaning:** make a bad situation worse.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** kept the wolf from the door → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** broke the ice → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** called it a day → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**28. After several failed attempts, the team decided to _____.**

A. throw in the towel

B. test the waters

C. call the shots

D. keep an eye on

**Answer: A. throw in the towel**
**Meaning:** give up.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** test the waters → try something cautiously first. **C.** call the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** keep an eye on → watch carefully.

**29. You should _____ the claims made in that advertisement.**

A. break the bank

B. take them with a grain of salt

C. hit the sack

D. go the extra mile

**Answer: B. take them with a grain of salt**
**Meaning:** not accept something as completely true.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** break the bank → cost a very large amount. **C.** hit the sack → go to bed. **D.** go the extra mile → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**30. Ignoring the safety warning is _____.**

A. calling it a day

B. keeping the ball rolling

C. playing with fire

D. seeing eye to eye

**Answer: C. playing with fire**
**Meaning:** take a dangerous risk.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** calling it a day → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** keeping the ball rolling → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** seeing eye to eye → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**31. She was _____ after receiving the scholarship.**

A. under the weather

B. in hot water

C. at a loss

D. on cloud nine

**Answer: D. on cloud nine**
**Meaning:** extremely happy.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** under the weather → feeling unwell. **B.** in hot water → in trouble. **C.** at a loss → confused or unsure what to do.

**32. I am feeling _____ today and will stay home.**

A. under the weather

B. on cloud nine

C. in the red

D. in black and white

**Answer: A. under the weather**
**Meaning:** feeling unwell.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** on cloud nine → extremely happy. **C.** in the red → in financial loss or debt. **D.** in black and white → in writing or clearly documented.

**33. Please _____ the equipment while I speak to the supervisor.**

A. jump the gun

B. keep an eye on

C. spill the beans

D. burn bridges

**Answer: B. keep an eye on**
**Meaning:** watch carefully.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** jump the gun → act too soon. **C.** spill the beans → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** burn bridges → destroy a relationship or possibility of returning.

**34. The resignation came _____ and surprised everyone.**

A. in the red

B. once in a blue moon

C. out of the blue

D. by the book

**Answer: C. out of the blue**
**Meaning:** unexpectedly.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** in the red → in financial loss or debt. **B.** once in a blue moon → very rarely. **D.** by the book → according to the rules.

**35. He visits his hometown only _____.**

A. at the drop of a hat

B. through thick and thin

C. by leaps and bounds

D. once in a blue moon

**Answer: D. once in a blue moon**
**Meaning:** very rarely.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** at the drop of a hat → immediately, without hesitation. **B.** through thick and thin → through good and bad times. **C.** by leaps and bounds → very rapidly.

**36. The company has been _____ since last year.**

A. in the red
B. on the ball
C. in the pink
D. under wraps

**Answer: A. in the red**
**Meaning:** in financial loss or debt.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** on the ball → alert and quick to understand. **C.** in the pink → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** under wraps → kept secret.

**37. The officer always does everything _____.**

A. under the table
B. by the book
C. out of the blue
D. at sea

**Answer: B. by the book**
**Meaning:** according to the rules.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** under the table → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** out of the blue → unexpectedly. **D.** at sea → confused or uncertain.

**38. The agreement is there _____ in the contract.**

A. on thin ice
B. out of the blue
C. in black and white
D. through thick and thin

**Answer: C. in black and white**
**Meaning:** in writing or clearly documented.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** on thin ice → in a risky situation. **B.** out of the blue → unexpectedly. **D.** through thick and thin → through good and bad times.

**39. The new assistant is really _____ and rarely misses a detail.**

A. under a cloud
B. in a pickle
C. at a loss
D. on the ball

**Answer: D. on the ball**
**Meaning:** alert and quick to understand.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** under a cloud → under suspicion or facing disgrace. **B.** in a pickle → in a difficult situation. **C.** at a loss → confused or unsure what to do.

**40. The employee was _____ after violating the safety rules.**

A. in hot water
B. on cloud nine
C. in the pink
D. off the hook

**Answer: A. in hot water**
**Meaning:** in trouble.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** on cloud nine → extremely happy. **C.** in the pink → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** off the hook → free from blame or responsibility.

**41. We are all _____ because the deadline has been moved forward.**

A. in black and white

B. in the same boat

C. on the ball

D. under wraps

**Answer: B. in the same boat**
**Meaning:** in the same difficult situation.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** in black and white → in writing or clearly documented. **C.** on the ball → alert and quick to understand. **D.** under wraps → kept secret.

**42. The board decided to _____ the failed project.**

A. bring home the bacon

B. test the waters

C. pull the plug on

D. keep the ball rolling

**Answer: C. pull the plug on**
**Meaning:** stop or terminate.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** bring home the bacon → earn money to support a family. **B.** test the waters → try something cautiously first. **D.** keep the ball rolling → keep a process going.

**43. Let's approve the next step to _____.**

A. throw in the towel

B. hit the roof

C. cut corners

D. keep the ball rolling

**Answer: D. keep the ball rolling**
**Meaning:** keep a process going.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** throw in the towel → give up. **B.** hit the roof → became extremely angry. **C.** cut corners → do something cheaply/carelessly by skipping proper steps.

**44. I cannot _____ this noise any longer.**

A. put up with

B. go cold turkey

C. miss the boat

D. call the shots

**Answer: A. put up with**
**Meaning:** tolerate.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** go cold turkey → stop a habit suddenly and completely. **C.** miss the boat → lose an opportunity. **D.** call the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**45. Both parents work hard to _____.**

A. jump the gun

B. bring home the bacon

C. beat a dead horse

D. break the ice

**Answer: B. bring home the bacon**
**Meaning:** earn money to support a family.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** jump the gun → act too soon. **C.** beat a dead horse → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** break the ice → make people feel more comfortable.

**46. There is no use _____ after the mistake has happened.**

A. calling the shots

B. going the extra mile

C. crying over spilt milk

D. cutting corners

**Answer: C. crying over spilt milk**
**Meaning:** regret something that cannot be changed.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** calling the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** going the extra mile → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** cutting corners → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**47. Many companies _____ and started offering AI tools.**

A. hit the sack

B. went under the weather

C. called it a day

D. jumped on the bandwagon

**Answer: D. jumped on the bandwagon**
**Meaning:** join a popular trend.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** hit the sack → go to bed. **B.** went under the weather → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** called it a day → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**48. The support team always _____ to help customers.**

A. goes the extra mile

B. cuts corners

C. misses the boat

D. throws in the towel

**Answer: A. goes the extra mile**
**Meaning:** make an additional effort.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** cuts corners → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** misses the boat → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** throws in the towel → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**49. Apply now or you may _____.**

A. keep your chin up

B. miss the boat

C. break the ice

D. hit the jackpot

**Answer: B. miss the boat**
**Meaning:** lose an opportunity.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** keep your chin up → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** break the ice → make people feel more comfortable. **D.** hit the jackpot → had great success or obtained something valuable.

**50. It is wiser to _____ than reopen the dispute.**

A. call the shots
B. spill the beans
C. let sleeping dogs lie
D. open a can of worms

**Answer: C. let sleeping dogs lie**
**Meaning:** avoid restarting an old conflict.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** call the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** spill the beans → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** open a can of worms → create a complicated set of problems.

**51. The audit _____ several hidden accounting errors.**

A. put on airs
B. ran out of steam
C. went cold turkey
D. brought to light

**Answer: D. brought to light**
**Meaning:** reveal or discover.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** put on airs → behave as if one is more important. **B.** ran out of steam → lost energy or enthusiasm. **C.** went cold turkey → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**52. He tends to _____ when important guests arrive.**

A. put on airs
B. keep an eye on
C. hit the sack
D. make ends meet

**Answer: A. put on airs**
**Meaning:** behave as if one is more important.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** keep an eye on → watch carefully. **C.** hit the sack → go to bed. **D.** make ends meet → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**53. The campaign _____ after several months.**

A. called the shots
B. ran out of steam
C. hit the jackpot
D. broke the ice

**Answer: B. ran out of steam**
**Meaning:** lose energy or enthusiasm.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** called the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** hit the jackpot → had great success or obtained something valuable. **D.** broke the ice → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**54. The supervisor _____ for repeatedly arriving late.**

A. put him on ice

B. let him off the hook

C. took him to task

D. gave him the green light

**Answer: C. took him to task**
**Meaning:** strongly criticize or reprimand.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** put him on ice → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** let him off the hook → release him from blame or punishment. **D.** gave him the green light → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**55. The proposal _____ because it ignored traditional safety practices.**

A. hit the sack

B. made ends meet

C. cut the mustard

D. went against the grain

**Answer: D. went against the grain**
**Meaning:** conflict with usual beliefs or preferences.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** hit the sack → go to bed. **B.** made ends meet → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** cut the mustard → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**56. The board finally _____ to the construction plan.**

A. gave the green light

B. put a lid on

C. held its horses

D. called the shots

**Answer: A. gave the green light**
**Meaning:** give permission to proceed.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** put a lid on → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** held its horses → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** called the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**57. The committee decided to _____ the proposal until next month.**

A. go bananas

B. put the proposal on ice

C. bring home the bacon

D. hit the roof

**Answer: B. put the proposal on ice**
**Meaning:** postpone something.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** go bananas → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** bring home the bacon → earn money to support a family. **D.** hit the roof → became extremely angry.

**58. _____! We need to verify the figures first.**

A. Cut corners
B. Break the bank
C. Hold your horses
D. Spill the beans

**Answer: C. Hold your horses**
**Meaning:** wait or be patient.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** Cut corners → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** Break the bank → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** Spill the beans → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**59. Buying the top model will _____.**

A. hit the roof
B. cut to the chase
C. draw a blank
D. break the bank

**Answer: D. break the bank**
**Meaning:** cost a very large amount.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** hit the roof → became extremely angry. **B.** cut to the chase → get to the main point. **C.** draw a blank → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**60. Dad will _____ when he sees the damaged car.**

A. hit the roof
B. hit the sack
C. hit the jackpot
D. hit the nail on the head

**Answer: A. hit the roof**
**Meaning:** become extremely angry.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** hit the sack → go to bed. **C.** hit the jackpot → had great success or obtained something valuable. **D.** hit the nail on the head → identify something exactly.

**61. When asked for the password, I _____.**

A. went the extra mile

B. drew a blank

C. hit the jackpot

D. called it a day

**Answer: B. drew a blank**
**Meaning:** be unable to remember or find an answer.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** went the extra mile → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** hit the jackpot → had great success or obtained something valuable. **D.** called it a day → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**62. The small company _____ with its new app.**

A. cut to the chase

B. was under the weather

C. hit the jackpot

D. went cold turkey

**Answer: C. hit the jackpot**
**Meaning:** have great success or obtain something valuable.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** cut to the chase → get to the main point. **B.** was under the weather → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** went cold turkey → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**63. He decided to _____ and stop using social media.**

A. call the shots

B. put on airs

C. burn bridges

D. go cold turkey

**Answer: D. go cold turkey**
**Meaning:** stop a habit suddenly and completely.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** call the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** put on airs → behave as if one is more important. **C.** burn bridges → destroy a relationship or possibility of returning.

**64. As project leader, Maya _____.**

A. calls the shots

B. cries over spilt milk

C. runs out of steam

D. misses the boat

**Answer: A. calls the shots**
**Meaning:** make important decisions.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** cries over spilt milk → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** runs out of steam → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** misses the boat → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**65. You are _____ after ignoring the manager's final warning.**

A. in the clear

B. on thin ice

C. on cloud nine

D. in the pink

**Answer: B. on thin ice**
**Meaning:** in a risky situation.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** in the clear → free from danger, blame, or difficulty. **C.** on cloud nine → extremely happy. **D.** in the pink → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**66. The details of the new product are still _____.**

A. in the red

B. out of the blue

C. under wraps

D. in the same boat

**Answer: C. under wraps**
**Meaning:** kept secret.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** in the red → in financial loss or debt. **B.** out of the blue → unexpectedly. **D.** in the same boat → in the same difficult situation.

**67. The investigation proved that the employee was _____.**

A. in hot water

B. at sea

C. in a pickle

D. in the clear

**Answer: D. in the clear**
**Meaning:** free from danger, blame, or difficulty.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** in hot water → in trouble. **B.** at sea → confused or uncertain. **C.** in a pickle → in a difficult situation.

**68. I was _____ when the computer suddenly stopped working.**

A. at a loss

B. on the ball

C. over the moon

D. in black and white

**Answer: A. at a loss**
**Meaning:** confused or unsure what to do.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** on the ball → alert and quick to understand. **C.** over the moon → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** in black and white → in writing or clearly documented.

**69. We were _____ when the only car broke down.**

A. at the drop of a hat

B. in a pickle

C. on the mend

D. in the pink

**Answer: B. in a pickle**
**Meaning:** in a difficult situation.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** at the drop of a hat → immediately, without hesitation. **C.** on the mend → recovering from illness or injury. **D.** in the pink → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**70. After the operation, he is slowly _____.**

A. under wraps

B. in the red

C. on the mend

D. on thin ice

**Answer: C. on the mend**
**Meaning:** recovering from illness or injury.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** under wraps → kept secret. **B.** in the red → in financial loss or debt. **D.** on thin ice → in a risky situation.

**71. The students were _____ after hearing the good news.**

A. at loggerheads

B. under a cloud

C. in a fix

D. in high spirits

**Answer: D. in high spirits**
**Meaning:** cheerful and happy.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** at loggerheads → in strong disagreement. **B.** under a cloud → under suspicion or facing disgrace. **C.** in a fix → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**72. The two departments are _____ over the budget.**

A. at loggerheads

B. on the ball

C. in the pink

D. under wraps

**Answer: A. at loggerheads**
**Meaning:** in strong disagreement.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** on the ball → alert and quick to understand. **C.** in the pink → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** under wraps → kept secret.

**73. The official remained _____ after the investigation.**

A. a piece of cake

B. under a cloud

C. on cloud nine

D. in high spirits

**Answer: B. under a cloud**
**Meaning:** under suspicion or facing disgrace.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** a piece of cake → something very easy. **C.** on cloud nine → extremely happy. **D.** in high spirits → cheerful and happy.

**74. The first exercise was _____.**

A. a close shave

B. a wild goose chase

C. as easy as pie

D. a storm in a teacup

**Answer: C. as easy as pie**
**Meaning:** very easy.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** a close shave → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** a wild goose chase → a pointless search. **D.** a storm in a teacup → a lot of fuss about a small matter.

**75. True friends stay together _____.**

A. at the drop of a hat
B. by leaps and bounds
C. under the table
D. through thick and thin

**Answer: D. through thick and thin**
**Meaning:** through good and bad times.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** at the drop of a hat → immediately, without hesitation. **B.** by leaps and bounds → very rapidly. **C.** under the table → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**76. She is ready to travel _____.**

A. at the drop of a hat
B. by the book
C. in black and white
D. once in a blue moon

**Answer: A. at the drop of a hat**
**Meaning:** immediately, without hesitation.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** by the book → according to the rules. **C.** in black and white → in writing or clearly documented. **D.** once in a blue moon → very rarely.

**77. The company's online sales have grown _____.**

A. in a pickle
B. by leaps and bounds
C. under a cloud
D. at loggerheads

**Answer: B. by leaps and bounds**
**Meaning:** very rapidly.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** in a pickle → in a difficult situation. **C.** under a cloud → under suspicion or facing disgrace. **D.** at loggerheads → in strong disagreement.

**78. The two runners were _____ near the finish line.**

A. in the red
B. off the hook
C. neck and neck
D. under the weather

**Answer: C. neck and neck**
**Meaning:** very close or equal in a competition.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** in the red → in financial loss or debt. **B.** off the hook → free from blame or responsibility. **D.** under the weather → feeling unwell.

**79. The company will _____ before launching nationally.**

A. spill the beans
B. hit the sack
C. put on airs
D. test the waters

**Answer: D. test the waters**
**Meaning:** try something cautiously first.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** spill the beans → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** hit the sack → go to bed. **C.** put on airs → behave as if one is more important.

**80. Never _____ when dealing with electrical safety.**

A. cut corners

B. keep an eye on

C. go the extra mile

D. call it a day

**Answer: A. cut corners**

**Meaning:** do something cheaply or carelessly by skipping proper steps.

**Why other options are wrong: B.** keep an eye on → watch carefully. **C.** go the extra mile → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** call it a day → stop working for the day.

**81. The mediator tried to _____ between the two teams.**

A. throw in the towel

B. smooth things over

C. hit the roof

D. miss the boat

**Answer: B. smooth things over**
**Meaning:** reduce tension or resolve disagreement.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** throw in the towel → give up. **C.** hit the roof → became extremely angry. **D.** miss the boat → lose an opportunity.

**82. After breaking the rules, he had to _____.**

A. jump the gun

B. go bananas

C. face the music

D. keep the wolf from the door

**Answer: C. face the music**
**Meaning:** accept the consequences.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** jump the gun → act too soon. **B.** go bananas → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** keep the wolf from the door → have enough money for basic needs.

**83. She works two jobs to _____.**

A. hit the jackpot

B. break the bank

C. pull someone's leg

D. keep the wolf from the door

**Answer: D. keep the wolf from the door**
**Meaning:** have enough money for basic needs.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** hit the jackpot → had great success or obtained something valuable. **B.** break the bank → cost a very large amount. **C.** pull someone's leg → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**84. Do not _____ before the official announcement.**

A. jump the gun

B. call it a day

C. hit the sack

D. go the extra mile

**Answer: A. jump the gun**
**Meaning:** act too soon.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** call it a day → stop working for the day. **C.** hit the sack → go to bed. **D.** go the extra mile → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**85. The crowd _____ when the singer appeared.**

A. called the shots

B. went bananas

C. kept its cards close

D. was in the red

**Answer: B. went bananas**
**Meaning:** become very excited or behave wildly.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** called the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** kept its cards close → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** was in the red → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**86. The negotiator _____ during the talks.**

A. broke the ice

B. called it a day

C. kept his cards close to his chest

D. hit the nail on the head

**Answer: C. kept his cards close to his chest**
**Meaning:** keep one's intentions secret.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** broke the ice → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** called it a day → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** hit the nail on the head → identify something exactly.

**87. Relax! I was only _____ when I said I had resigned.**

A. cutting corners

B. calling the shots

C. throwing in the towel

D. pulling your leg

**Answer: D. pulling your leg**
**Meaning:** tease or joke with someone.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** cutting corners → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** calling the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** throwing in the towel → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**88. The coach _____ after the team ignored instructions.**

A. read the riot act

B. kept the ball rolling

C. went cold turkey

D. took it with a grain of salt

**Answer: A. read the riot act**
**Meaning:** strongly reprimand or warn.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** kept the ball rolling → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** went cold turkey → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** took it with a grain of salt → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**89. The old machine no longer _____.**

A. keeps the wolf from the door

B. cuts the mustard

C. breaks the ice

D. hits the sack

**Answer: B. cuts the mustard**
**Meaning:** meet the required standard.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** keeps the wolf from the door → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** breaks the ice → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** hits the sack → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**90. The evidence proved she was _____.**

A. on thin ice
B. under a cloud
C. off the hook
D. in hot water

**Answer: C. off the hook**
**Meaning:** free from blame or responsibility.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** on thin ice → in a risky situation. **B.** under a cloud → under suspicion or facing disgrace. **D.** in hot water → in trouble.

**91. Without the instructions, the new employee was completely _____.**

A. on cloud nine
B. in the clear
C. under wraps
D. at sea

**Answer: D. at sea**
**Meaning:** confused or uncertain.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** on cloud nine → extremely happy. **B.** in the clear → free from danger, blame, or difficulty. **C.** under wraps → kept secret.

**92. He was _____ after failing the final interview.**

A. down in the dumps
B. in the pink
C. on the ball
D. in the clear

**Answer: A. down in the dumps**
**Meaning:** sad or unhappy.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** in the pink → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** on the ball → alert and quick to understand. **D.** in the clear → free from danger, blame, or difficulty.

**93. The new measures may _____ future attacks.**

A. break the ice
B. ward off
C. spill the beans
D. pull the plug on

**Answer: B. ward off**
**Meaning:** prevent or avoid something undesirable.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** break the ice → make people feel more comfortable. **C.** spill the beans → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** pull the plug on → stop or terminate.

**94. The evidence seems to _____ her version of events.**

A. call it a day
B. put on airs
C. bear out
D. cut corners

**Answer: C. bear out**
**Meaning:** confirm or support.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** call it a day → stop working for the day. **B.** put on airs → behave as if one is more important. **D.** cut corners → do something cheaply/carelessly by skipping proper steps.

**95. Please _____ the report before submitting it.**

A. hit the roof

B. throw in the towel

C. go bananas

D. go over

**Answer: D. go over**
**Meaning:** review or examine carefully.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** hit the roof → became extremely angry. **B.** throw in the towel → give up. **C.** go bananas → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**96. The date of the event is still _____.**

A. up in the air

B. in black and white

C. on cloud nine

D. by the book

**Answer: A. up in the air**
**Meaning:** undecided or uncertain.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** in black and white → in writing or clearly documented. **C.** on cloud nine → extremely happy. **D.** by the book → according to the rules.

**97. The sudden cancellation _____ the entire team.**

A. brought home the bacon

B. threw the entire team into a tailspin

C. put on airs

D. kept the ball rolling

**Answer: B. threw the entire team into a tailspin**
**Meaning:** put someone into confusion or disorder.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** brought home the bacon → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** put on airs → behave as if one is more important. **D.** kept the ball rolling → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**98. My old laptop finally _____ during the presentation.**

A. called the shots

B. hit the nail on the head

C. gave up the ghost

D. broke the ice

**Answer: C. gave up the ghost**
**Meaning:** stop working or die.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** called the shots → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **B.** hit the nail on the head → identify something exactly. **D.** broke the ice → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**99. The negotiator decided to _____ until more evidence appeared.**

A. jump the gun

B. spill the beans

C. cut the mustard

D. keep his powder dry

**Answer: D. keep his powder dry**
**Meaning:** remain prepared and avoid acting too soon.
**Why other options are wrong: A.** jump the gun → act too soon. **B.** spill the beans → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **C.** cut the mustard → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.

**100. The extra practice helped _____ the lost time.**

A. make up for

B. put on airs

C. run out of steam

D. draw a blank

**Answer: A. make up for**
**Meaning:** compensate for something.
**Why other options are wrong: B.** put on airs → behave as if one is more important. **C.** run out of steam → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here. **D.** draw a blank → an expression with a different meaning from the one required here.